Microsoft Word

For Non-Profit Grant Writers

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2023 Microsoft®

Microsoft Word for Non-Profit Grant Writers

User Manual

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Executive Summary

This guide is for Microsoft Word as part of the Microsoft 365 product family.

As a user of Microsoft Word, since the days of Windows XP, I present to you *Microsoft Word for Non-profit Grant Writers*. Microsoft Word is a robust word processing tool that will help you create pristine documents that will convince Grantmakers to provide you with funding.

Like a grant proposal, this manual will begin with a brief introduction of Word's features and lead to details on how to utilize them in your documents. After reading this manual you will become an experienced user of Microsoft Word, ready to take on any grant writing tasks that may come your way!

This guide is not intended to teach you every feature of Word, but to provide you with the tools that are most useful to you—the grant writer. The chapters are organized in the style of a tutorial to guide you through the features of Word. However, this manual can be read out of order as you see fit.

Project Description

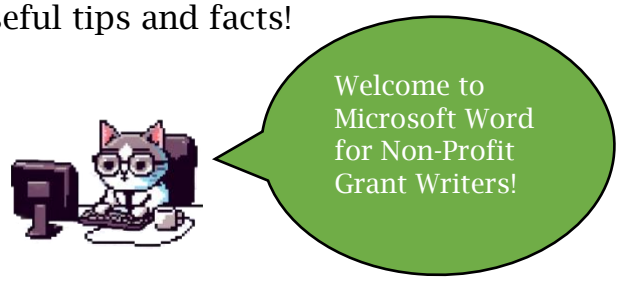
Chapter 1: Getting Started provides you with a quick overview of Microsoft Word. This chapter includes a quick start guide and useful keyboard shortcuts to help get you writing as soon as possible.

Chapter 2: Formatting Your Grant Proposal walks you through features that are necessary for organizing your grant proposals. In this chapter you will learn how to set default fonts, customize styles, insert hyperlinks, and design your own headers and footers.

Chapter 3: Editing Your Document is the most important part of writing grant proposals. This chapter will cover a wide range of features to assist you with editing your document. This includes combining documents, using various view modes, and checking your document for spelling or grammar errors.

Chapter 4: Finalizing Your Document is a short concluding chapter that shows you how to save your hard work and convert your Word document into a file that is easily accessible.

To help guide you through this manual, Gerry the Grant Writing Cat will appear throughout with useful tips and facts!



Acknowledgements

Microsoft Word for Non-profit Grant Writers aims to help guide individuals, who write for the benefit of others, through the intricacies of this word processing software. This manual would not have been possible without the brilliant minds who provided me with valuable feedback and recommendations to make this the best manual that I can produce. Thank you to my sister Tariana, without you this manual would not be possible—your passion for non-profit organizations inspired me; Elliot and Mia for having the patience and sparing me your precious time to test out my modules; and Professor Solberg for constantly pushing me to produce my best work. Last, but not least, I would like to thank my pet Floyd for keeping me company on my most stressful days and providing me with inspiration for Gerry—you are such a good boy!

More importantly, this manual would not be possible without you! I hope that after reading this you gain a better understanding of Microsoft Word and can apply this to your own documents as you strive to make the world a better place, one grant proposal at a time!

Chapter 1

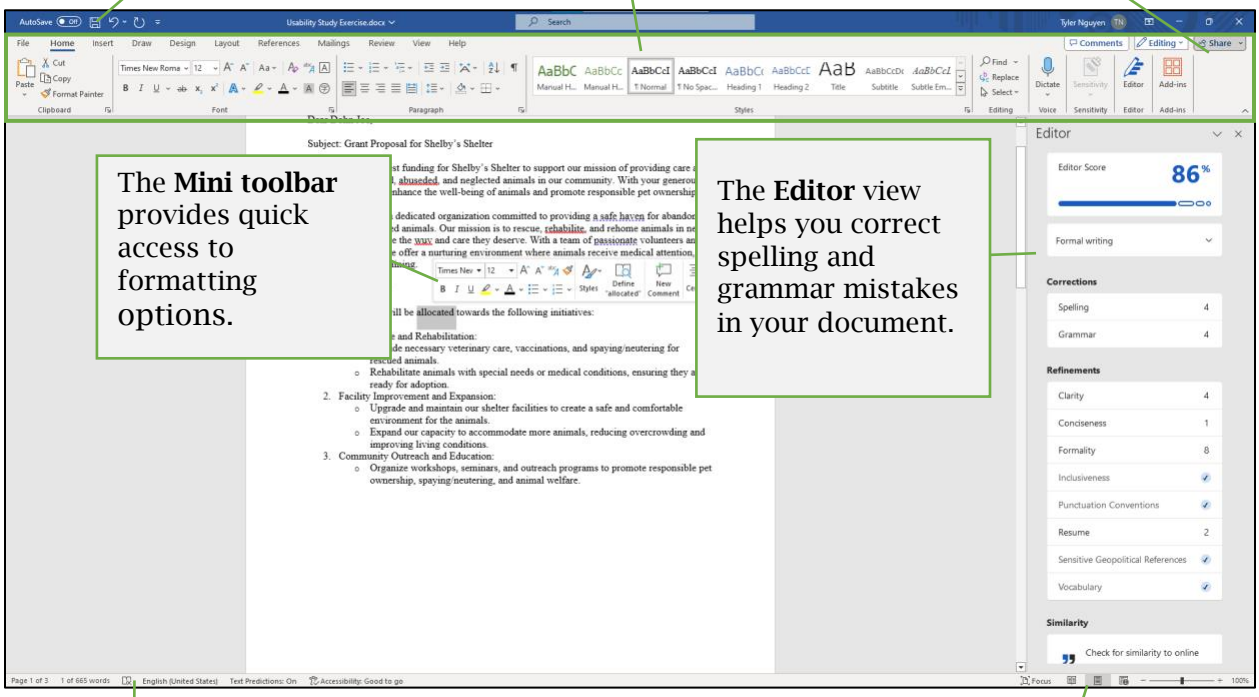
1.1 Quick Start Reference Guide

Use this guide to quickly learn basic features or familiarize yourself with the interface.

Save your work on your local machine or one OneDrive.

The **Ribbon** is the toolbar that contains various features and commands.

Share your document with collaborators to view or edit your document.



The **Mini toolbar** provides quick access to formatting options.

The **Editor** view helps you correct spelling and grammar mistakes in your document.

The **Status bar** provides various statistics and shortcuts such as word count and page navigation.

Use the **View** options to change the page display or zoom in and out.

1.2 Keyboard Shortcuts

Keyboard shortcuts are keypress combinations that execute actions within Microsoft Word. As a grant writer, you are too busy with obtaining money for your non-profit organization to have to worry about memorizing keyboard shortcuts. Lucky for you this manual includes this handy shortcut page that you can refer to. By utilizing shortcuts, you can save time and work more efficiently.

Editing Shortcuts

Ctrl + N	Create a new document	**Ctrl + C**	Copy
Ctrl + S	Save document	**Ctrl + V**	Paste
Ctrl + Z	Undo last action	**Ctrl + X**	Cut
Ctrl + Y	Redo last action	**Shift + Enter**	New line
Ctrl + A	Select all	**Ctrl + Enter**	Page break
Ctrl + P	Print	**Ctrl + B**	Enable bold text

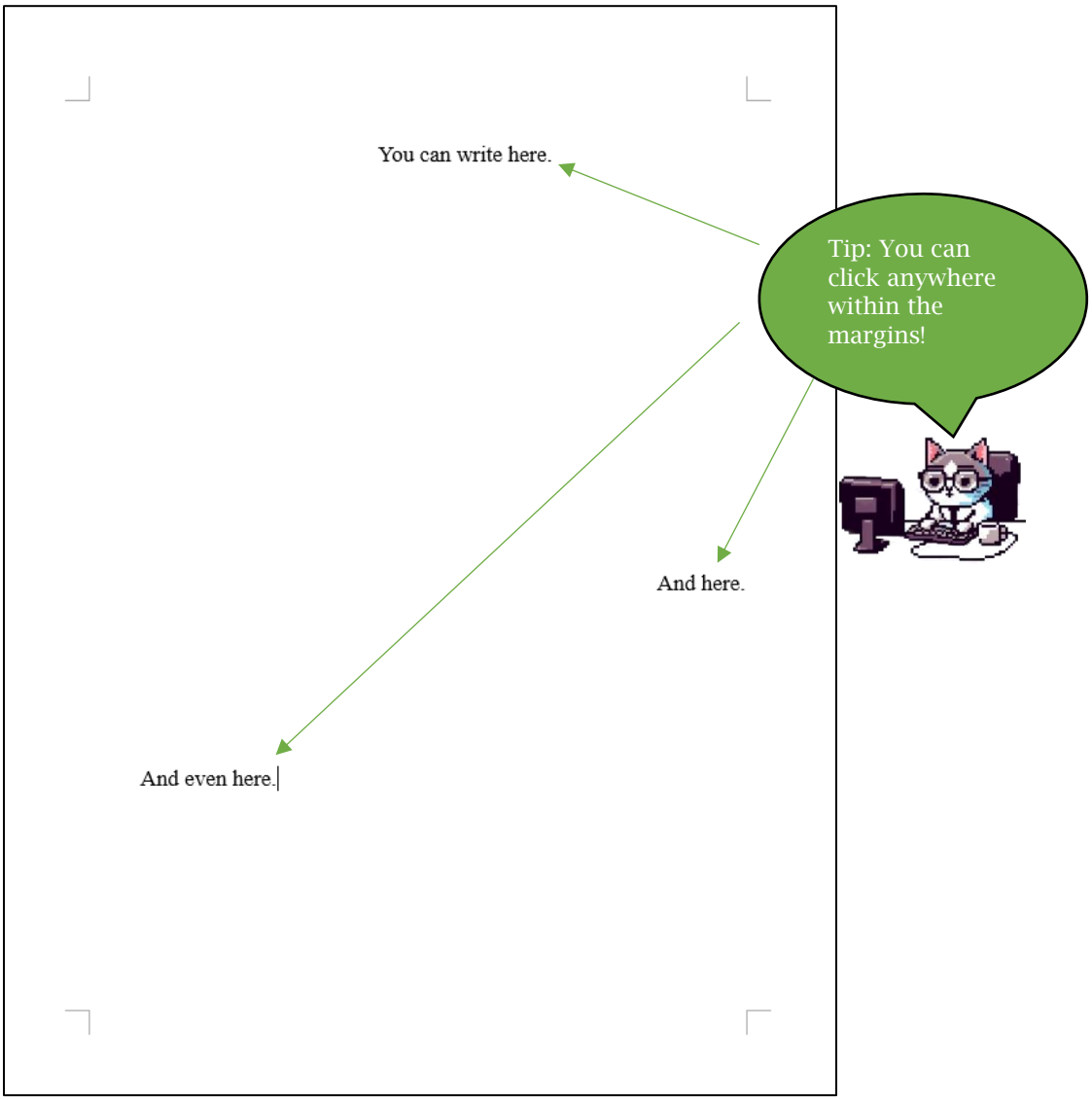
Navigation Shortcuts

Ctrl + F	Find text
Home	Move to the start of a line
End	Move to the end of a line
Page Up	Move to the next page
Page Down	Move to the previous page
CTRL + F4	Close current document

1.3 Start Writing in Microsoft Word

Microsoft Word allows you to type anywhere on the page with just a click of your mouse. This helps you to quickly get your ideas anywhere on the page without having to worry about formatting.

1. Double click with your mouse on the page. Your cursor is placed in the space that you clicked on.
2. Start typing.

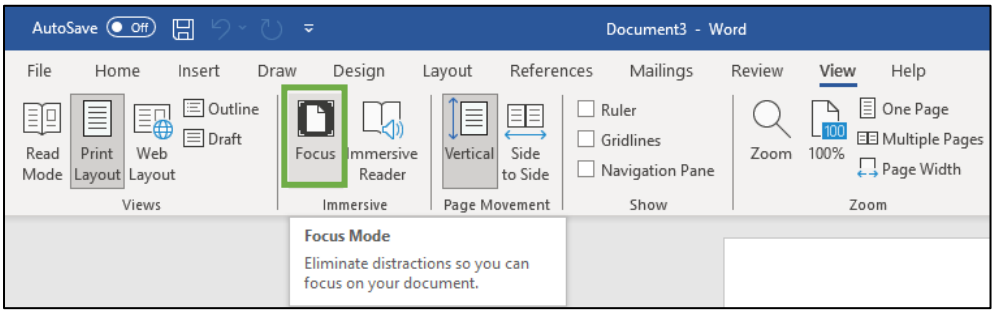


1.4 Focus Mode

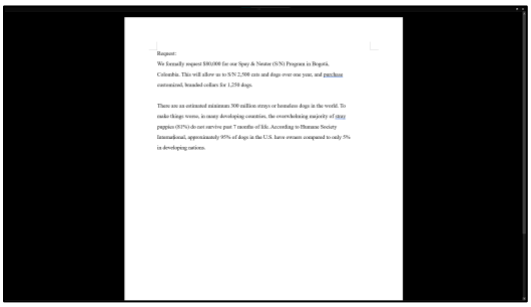
Microsoft Word's overwhelming interface may prevent you from concentrating on your work. Focus mode creates a distraction-free environment that helps direct your attention to writing your document.

Method 1: Focus Mode on the View Tab

1. Navigate to the **View** tab on the ribbon.
2. Click **Focus.**

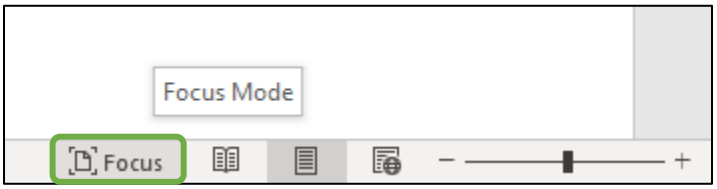


The interface is hidden and your page appears over a black background.



Method 2: Focus Mode Button

1. Click on the **Focus** icon at the bottom right of the screen.



Tip: This can be useful for distraction free reading, especially when in a document full of comments. See Chapter 3 for more info on comments.

Method 3: Focus Mode Shortcut

1. Press the **Alt** + **W** + **O** key.

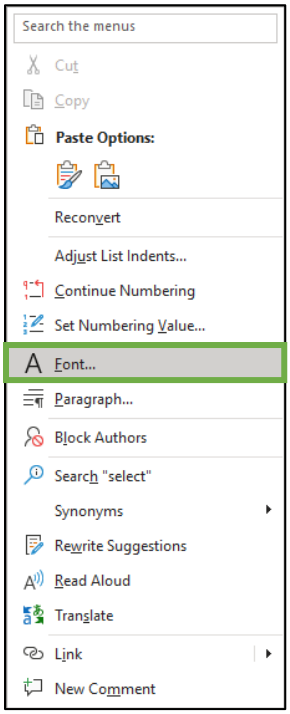
Note: Press the **esc** key to exit out of focus mode.

Chapter 2

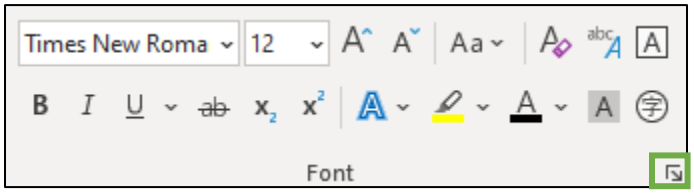
2.1 Set the Default Font

Before you begin writing your grant proposals, you may find yourself needing to change the font and its size. In Word you can change the default settings to minimize the time spent changing your settings and maximize your time spent writing.

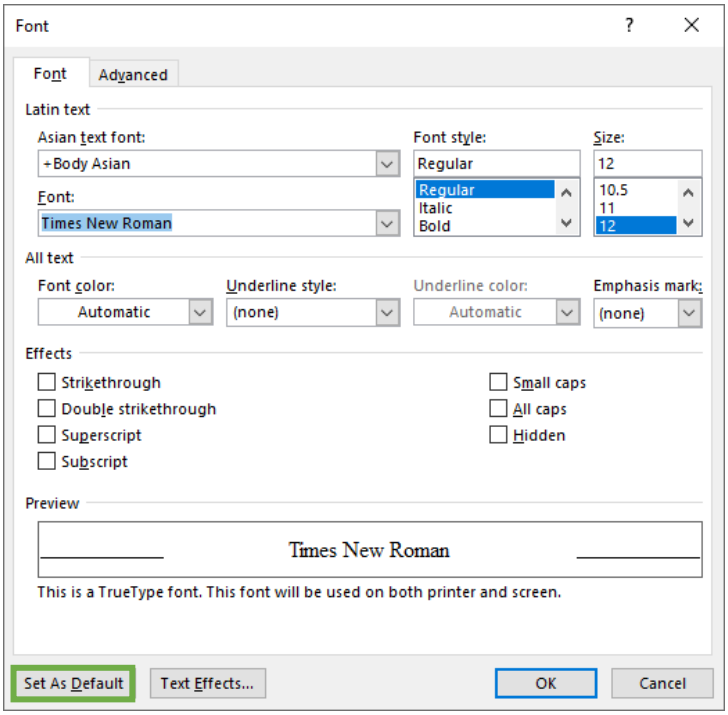
1. Right-click anywhere on your screen and click the **Font** option. A box appears.



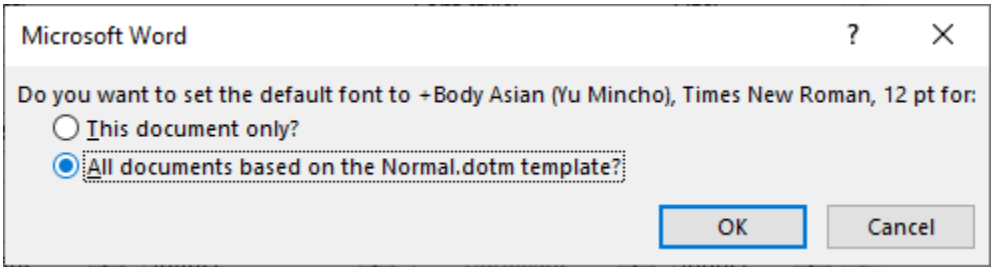
Optional: Alternatively, the **Font** menu can be accessed from the **Home** tab. Click the arrow icon in the bottom right of the **Font** section.



2. Select your desired font using the drop-down menu and click **Set as Default**.



3. Click the **All documents based on the Normal template** button to set the default font for future documents.

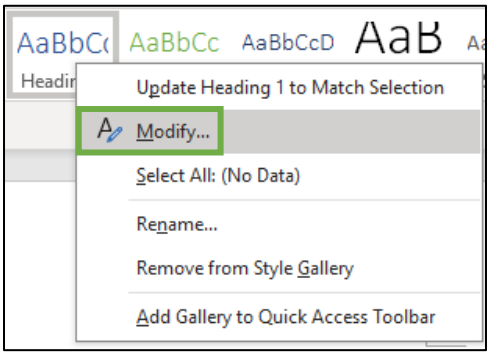


2.2 Create Custom Styles

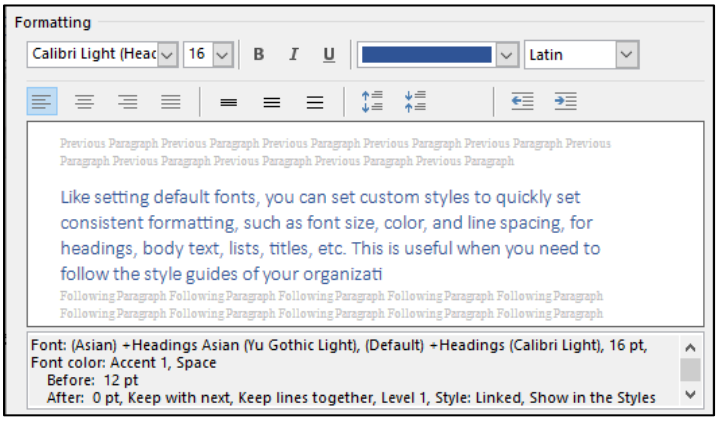
Like setting default fonts, you can set custom styles to quickly set consistent formatting, such as font size, color, and line spacing, for headings, body text, lists, titles, etc. This is useful when you need to follow the style guides of your organization.

Method 1: Modify an Existing Style

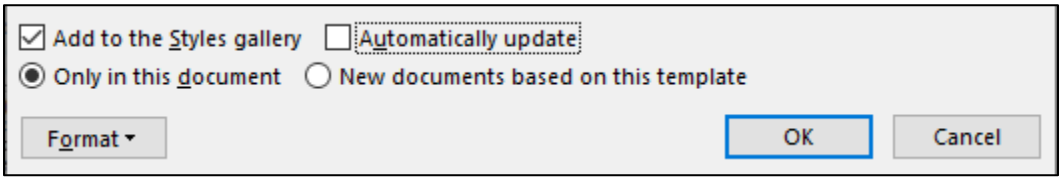
1. Right-click on a style in the **Home** tab and select **Modify**. The **Modify Style** dialog box appears.



2. Edit the style properties using the settings in the **Formatting** section.

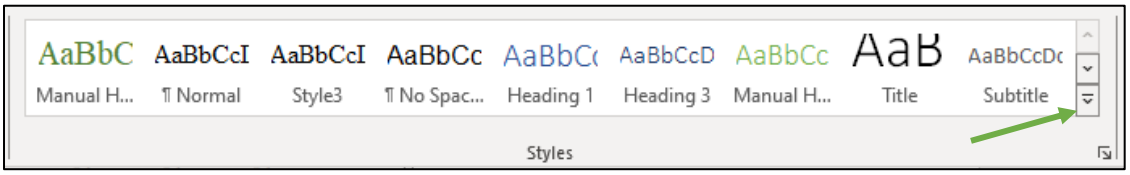


3. Click **Only in this document** to apply changes to this style in the current document only or **New documents based on this template** to save this style for future documents. Click **OK** when finished.

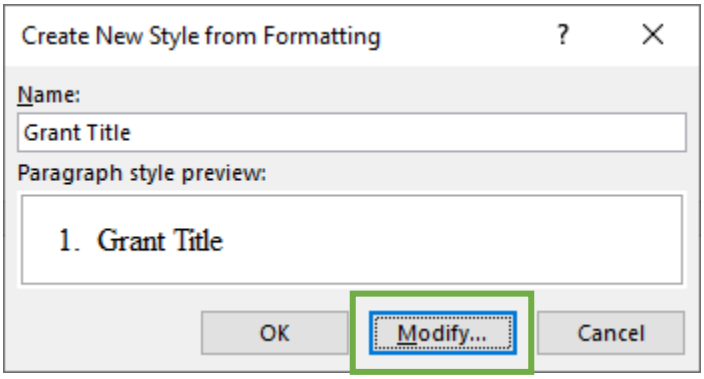


Method 2: Create a Style

1. Click the drop-down menu in the **Styles** section and, in the menu, click on **Create a Style**. A dialog box appears.



2. Name your style and click **Modify.**

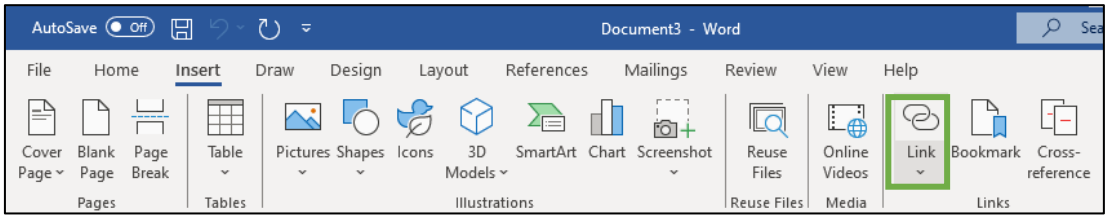


3. Follow steps 2-3 from method 1 to edit and apply the style.

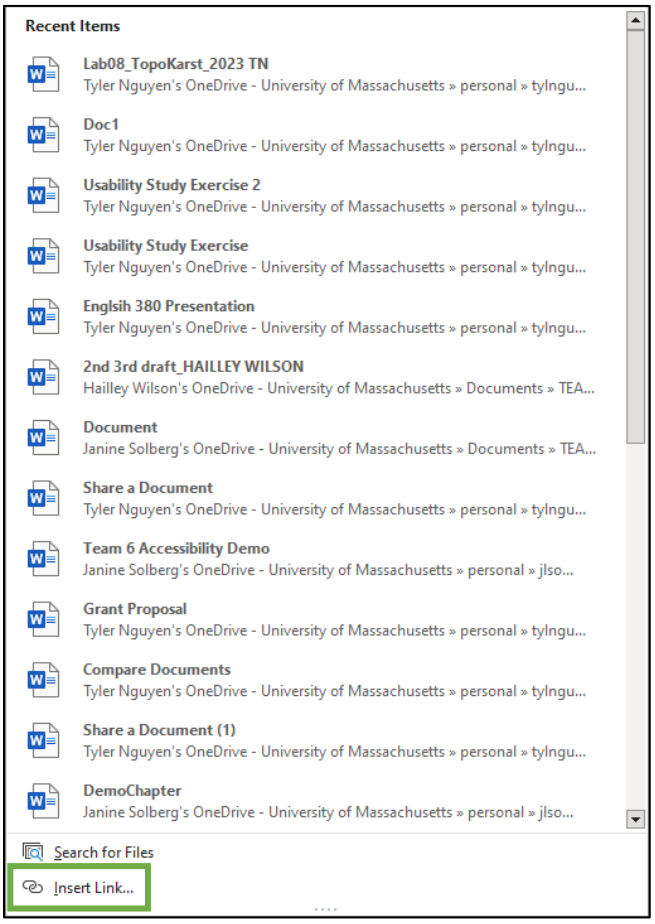
2.3 Insert a Hyperlink

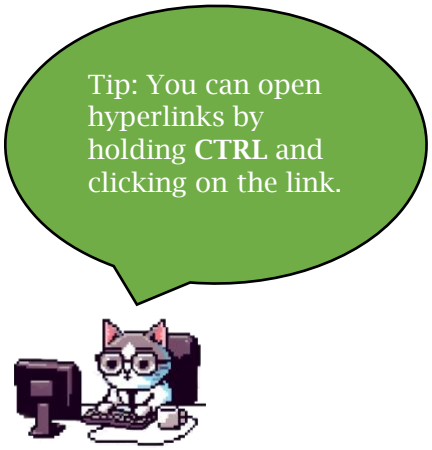
A hyperlink is a convenient way of directing your reader to other documents or resources on the web. For example, you can seamlessly integrate a webpage, such as your organization's website, into the document.

1. Select the text that you want to become a hyperlink.
2. Navigate to the **Insert** tab and click on the **Link** button. A drop-down menu appears.

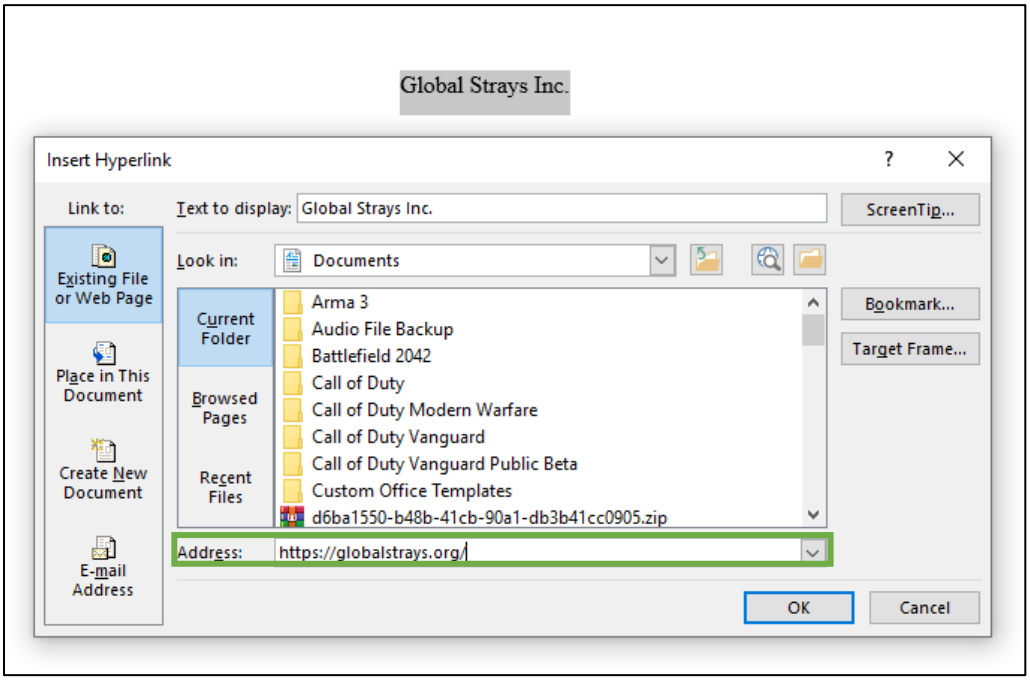


3. Click **Insert Link** to bring up the **Insert Hyperlink** dialog box.





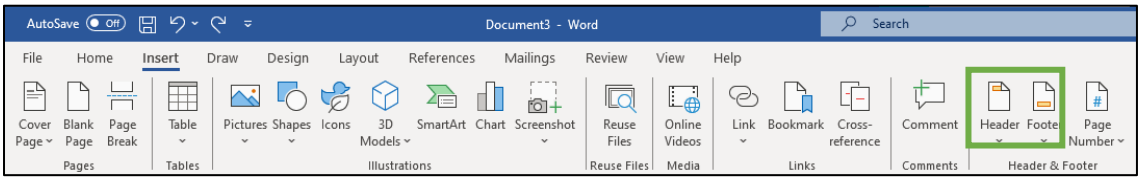
4. Insert the URL of the website in the **Address** bar. Make sure that the **Existing File or Web Page** option is selected and then click **OK.** The text you selected is underlined and becomes blue, indicating hyperlinked text.



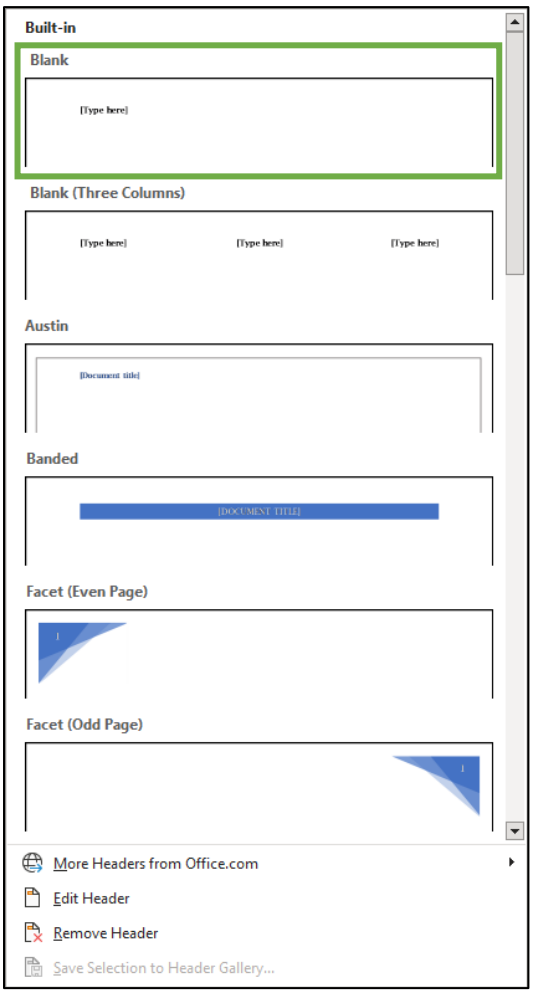
2.4 Adding Images in the Header or Footer

Inserting images in the header or footer is useful for implementing designs into your document, such as a company logo.

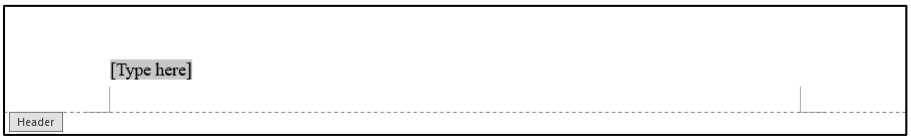
1. Navigate to the **Insert** tab on the ribbon.



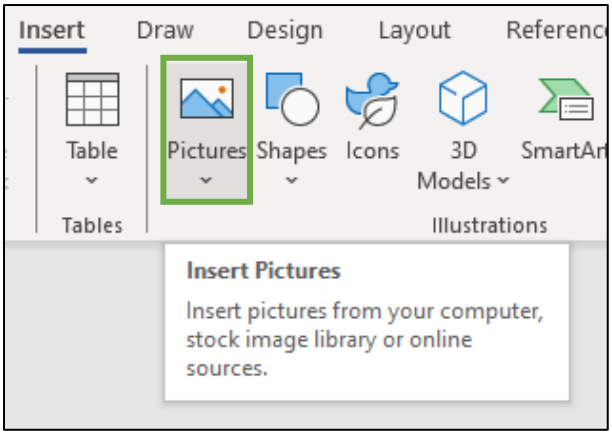
2. Click Header or Footer. A drop-down menu appears.
3. Select the **Blank** template.



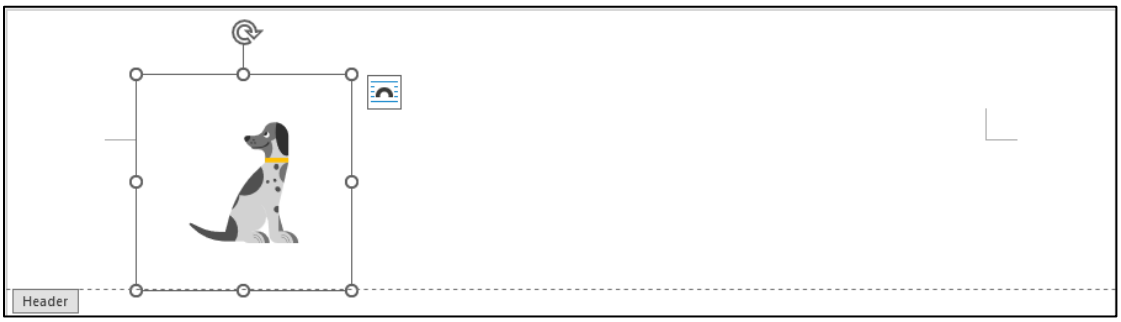
4. Type in your text or delete the template text.



5. Click **Pictures** to insert an image.



6. Select the image that you want to insert into your header.



Note: Depending on the size of the image, you may need to resize and reposition it.

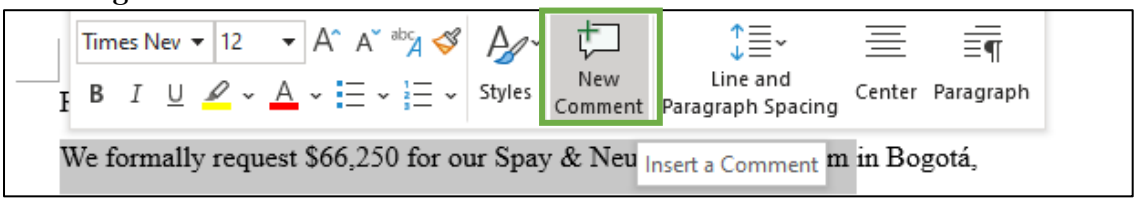
7. Click on **Close Header and Footer** or double click into the body of the document when you are finished.

Chapter 3

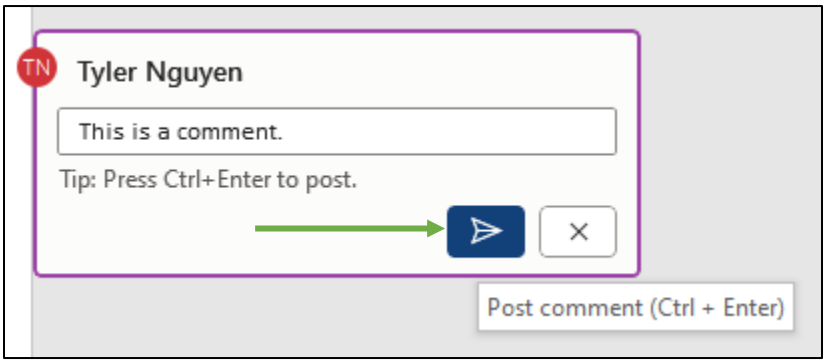
3.1 Adding Comments

An important aspect of grant writing is the review process. Comments allow you to make suggestions to a document without directly altering the work.

1. Select the text that you want to comment on. The mini toolbar appears after releasing the click.



2. Click on **New Comment**. A box appears next to the page.
3. Type your comment and click the arrow to post the comment.



Note: You can navigate through comments by clicking on the

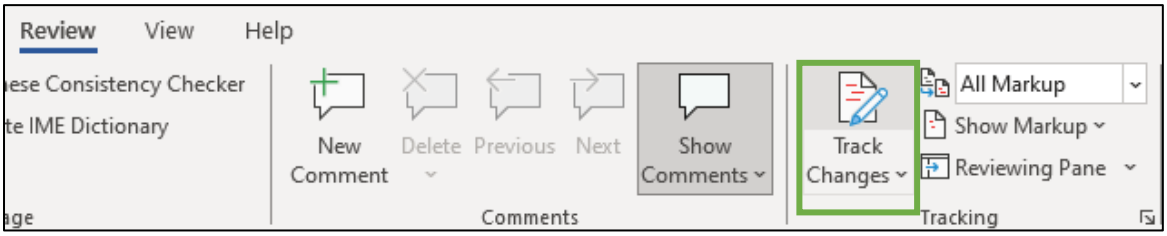
and

buttons under the **Review** tab.

3.2 Tracking Changes

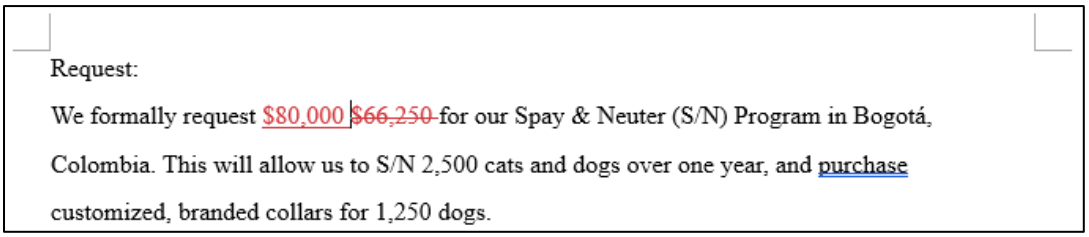
When you need to make definitive edits, you can track the changes that you make to a document. Track changes allow you and your collaborators to know exactly where adjustments are made.

1. Click on **Track Changes** in the Review tab. The Document access mode changes from **Editing** to **Reviewing**.



2. Make your edits to the document. Edits you make in Reviewing mode are highlighted in red text.

   Example:



Note: Saving your document saves tracked changes. Now you can send the document to others for feedback.

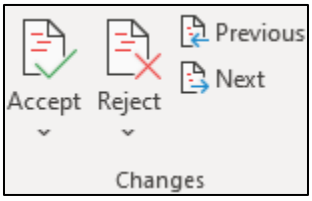
3.3 Accepting and Rejecting Changes

You can navigate through edits by using the buttons in the **Changes** section of the **Review** tab. From here, you can step through edits or accept and reject changes made to the document.

1. Click on

or

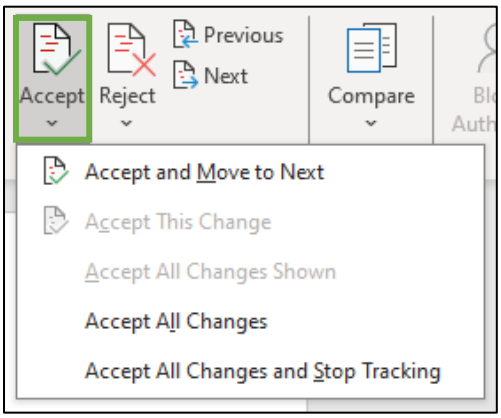
, in the **Changes** tab, to highlight changes in the document.
2. Click **Accept** to keep the change or **Reject** to undo the change.



3. Repeat these steps until you review all changes to the document.

Accept or Reject All Changes

1. Click on the drop-down arrow under **Accept** or **Reject**.



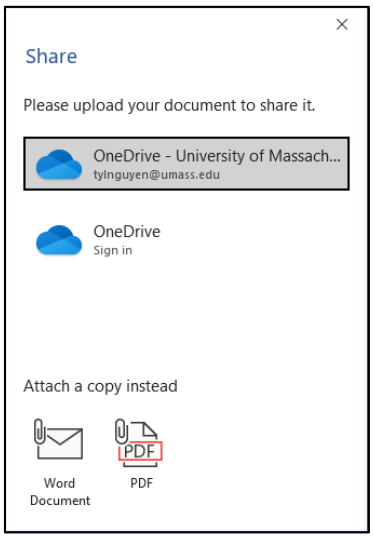
2. Select **Accept All Changes** to apply all edits.
   Select **Reject All Changes** to undo all edits.

3.4 Share a Document

Microsoft Word makes it easy to distribute documents to other collaborators with its built-in sharing feature. Collaborators are notified through email and can view or edit your document.

1. Click the **Share** button.

2. Save your document to OneDrive. A dialog box appears with a field to enter your collaborators and a message.

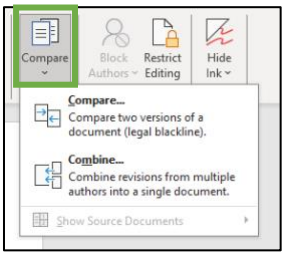


3. Enter the emails of your collaborators, and if you would like, add a message.
4. Click on the **Can view** button to change the permissions of your collaborators.
5. Click **Send** to send the document to your collaborators.
   An email with a link is sent that directs them to a new window and displays your document in their web browser.

3.5 Compare Documents

The compare feature allows you to match two documents. This is useful when you receive a revised document without comments or tracked changes to indicate new content added by collaborators. Rather than risking errors, you can use the Compare feature to indicate the differences in the document.

1. Click on the **Compare** button in the **Review** tab. A drop-down menu appears and click **Compare**.

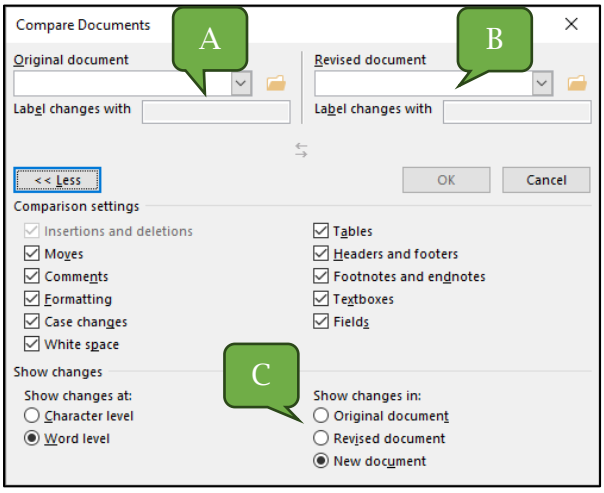


2. Complete the following steps:

   a) **Original Document** - Choose the initial document that you want to compare.

   b) **Revised Document** - Choose the new document that you want to compare.

   c) **Show Changes In** - Make sure **New document** is selected. Microsoft Word creates a new document by default with the changes highlighted. Alternatively, you can click the **Original document** or **Revised document** radio buttons if you do not want to create a new document.



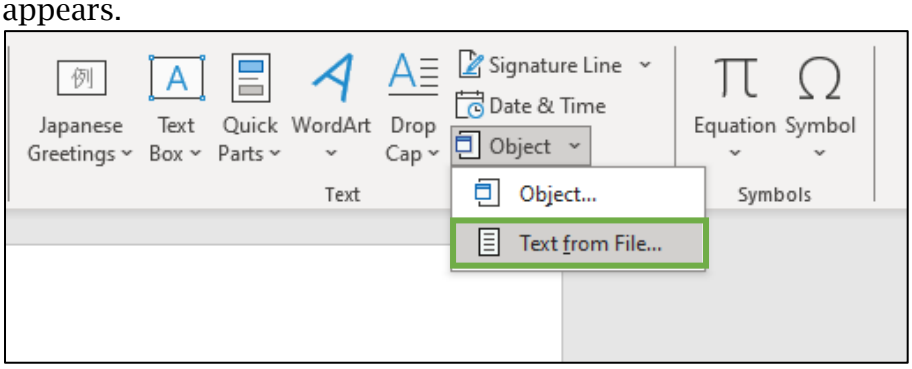
> **Note:** Enter a label in the **Label changes with** field to mark differences more clearly in a document. It may be useful to set the label as the editor's name.

3. Click **OK** to compare the documents.

3.6 Combine Documents

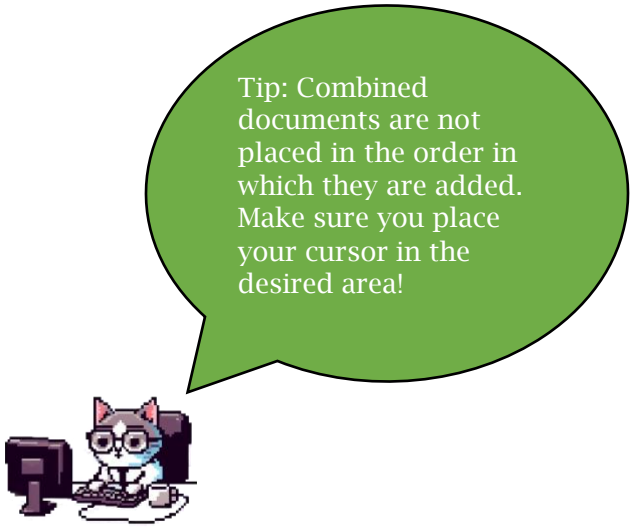
In Microsoft Word, you can combine multiple documents without going through the process of copying and pasting from one document to another.

1. Click on the **Object** button located in the **Insert** tab.
2. Choose the **Text from File** option from the drop-down menu. A dialog box appears.



3. Select the document that you want to combine. This will open the document and place its content in your new document. The text, images, and formatting from your selected document are added to the current document.

   Add another document by placing your cursor in the desired area and repeat the steps.

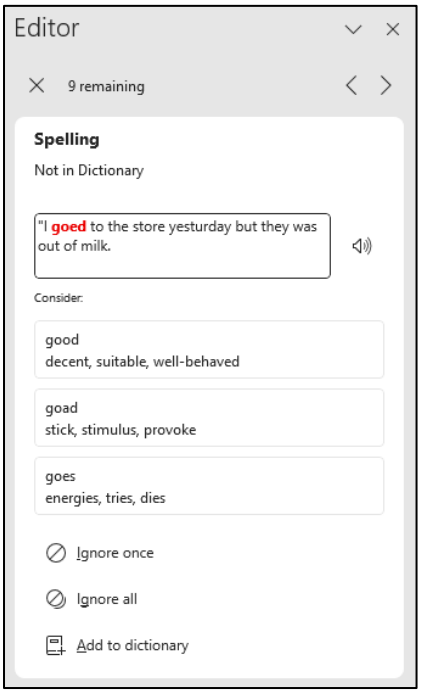


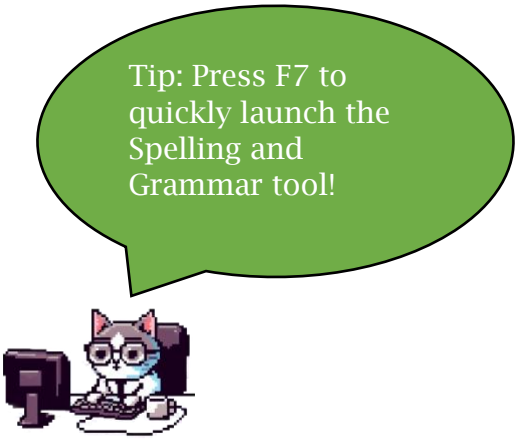
3.7 Check for Spelling and Grammatical Errors

Your grant proposals must be without spelling or grammar errors to ensure your organization's best chance to receive funding. The Spelling and Grammar tool can help ensure your document is error-free. In addition to the Spelling and Grammar tool, the Editor View is a valuable tool for refining your documents.

Spelling and Grammar

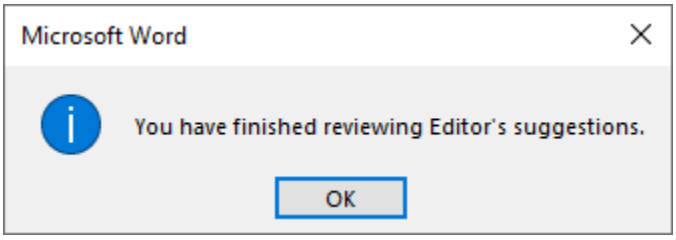
1. Click on the **Spelling and Grammar** button in the **Review** tab. The Editor menu appears and displays the mistakes in the document. The menu also displays suggestions to correct your mistake.





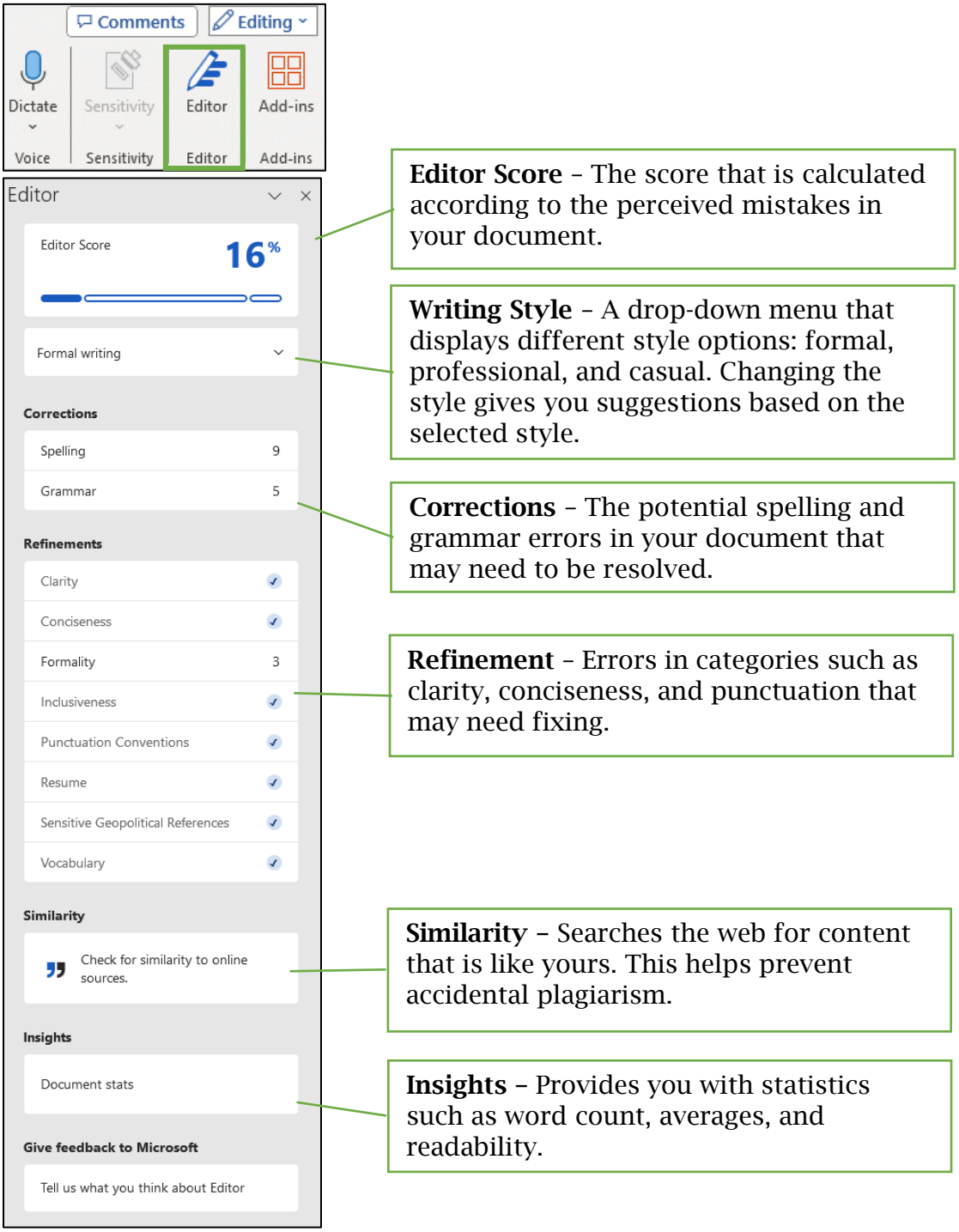
Note: In this example, the suggestions are incorrect. Be sure to review the errors making the change.

2. Use the arrows to cycle through the mistakes in your document.
3. Choose a suggested change or select **Ignore** if you are certain it is not an error. A dialog appears when you resolve all errors.
4. Click **OK** to finish.



Editor View

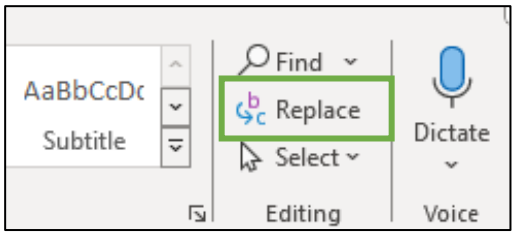
1. Click the **Editor** button in the **Home** tab. The Editor menu appears that displays insights into your document.



3.8 Find and Replace Text

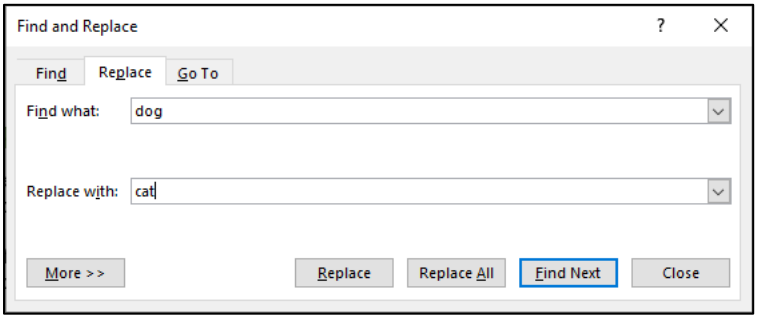
The Find and Replace tool is a useful feature that can change words or sentences throughout your document quickly and efficiently. For example, if you finish your proposal but realize you misspelled the institution's name, you can use the Find and Replace tool to fix your errors without having to go through the painstaking process of manually sifting through your document.

1. Click on **Replace** located in the **Home** tab. The **Find and Replace** dialog box appears.

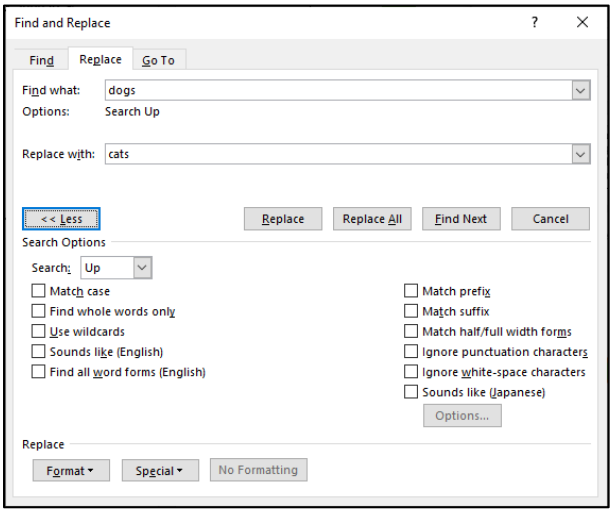


2. Type the word you want to replace in the **Find what** text box**.**
   Type the word you want to replace it with in the **Replace with** text boxes.

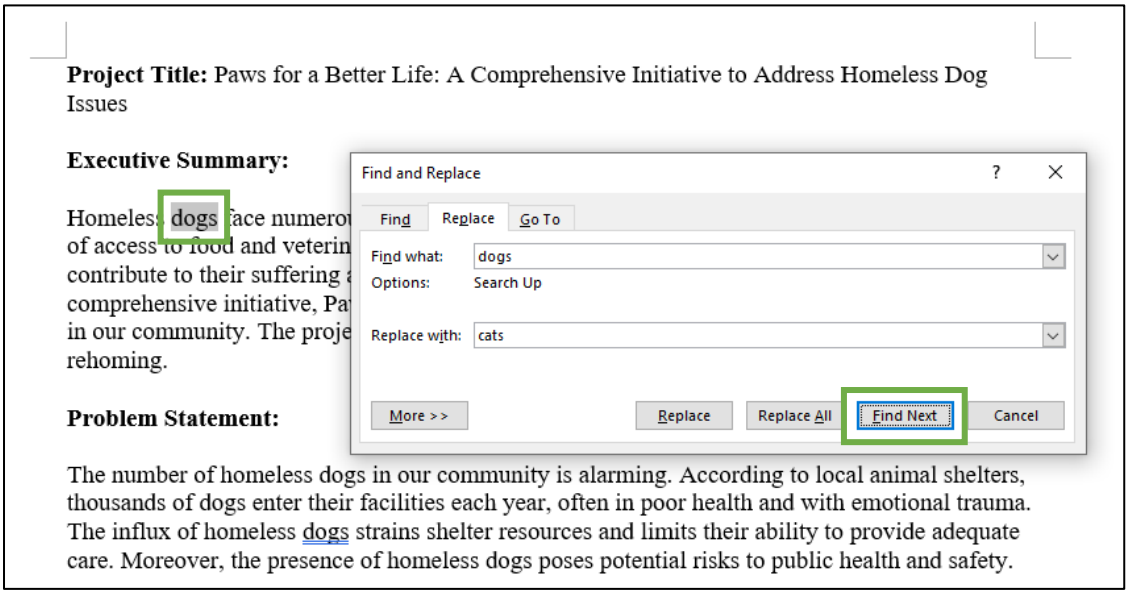
   In this example the previous grant writer wrote the proposal for dogs instead of cats. Every time the word dog occurs you replace it with the word cat.



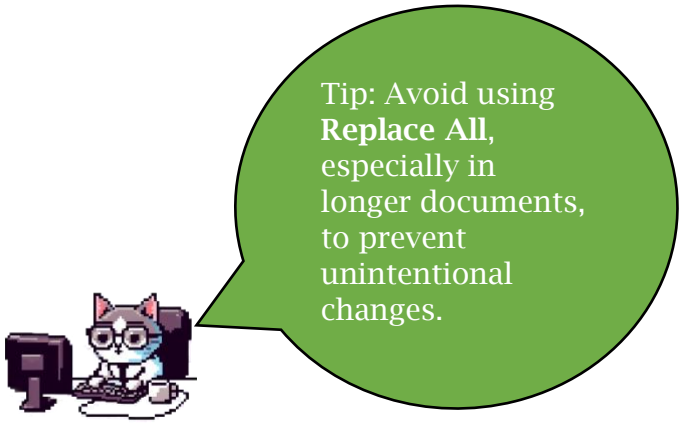
Note: Click on **More** for additional options to refine your search or change the direction of your search.



3. Click **Find Next** to find places where your word or phrase occurs and is highlighted in your document.



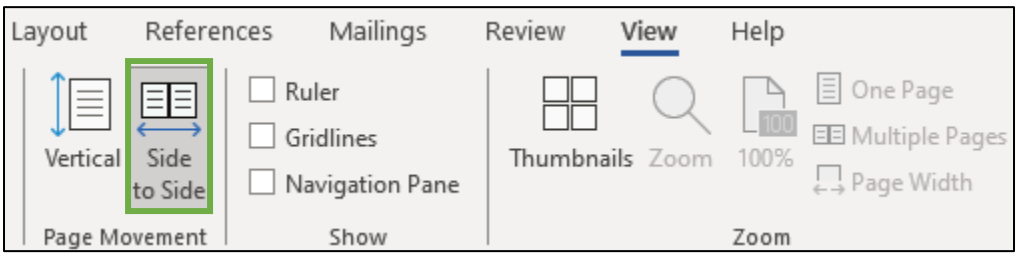
4. Click **Replace** to change the targeted word or phrase.
5. Repeat steps 3 and 4 until you resolve all the changes.



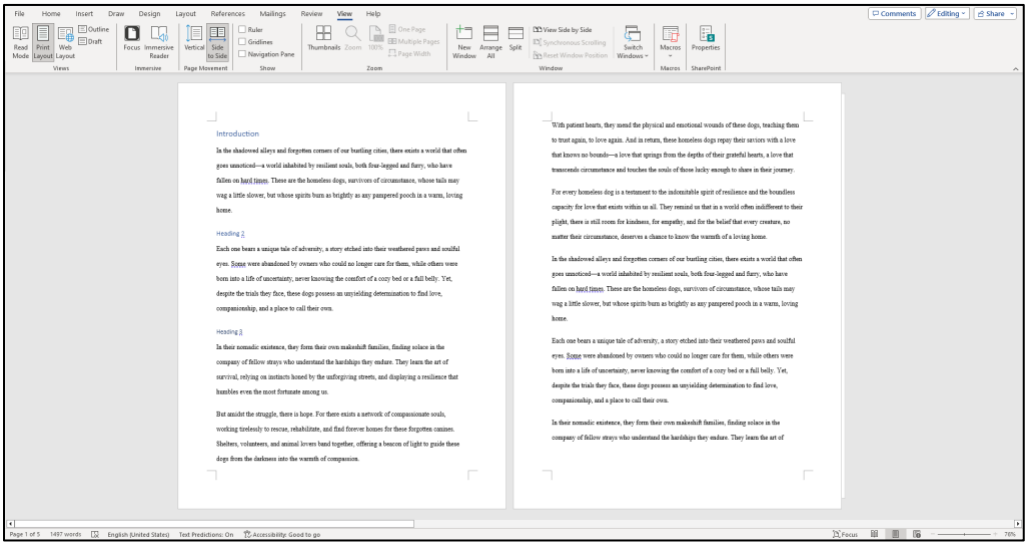
3.9 View Pages Side to Side

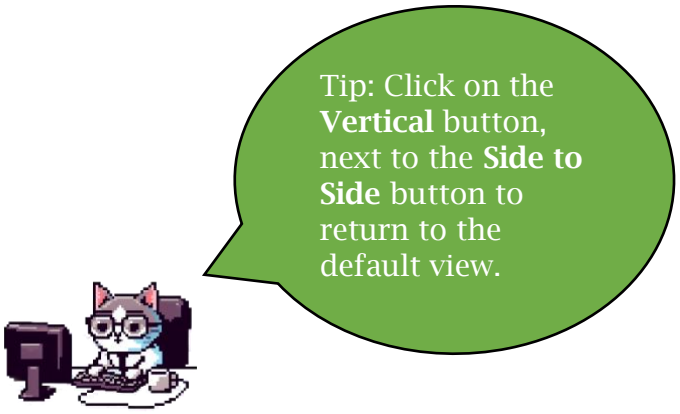
The Side to Side View allows for a book-like page view when working through your document. This can make viewing longer documents less tiresome as it requires less scrolling, and you can view two pages at once. Side to Side view also gives you access to the thumbnails, where you can see all the pages in your document in a single view.

1. Click on **Side to Side** in the **View** tab.



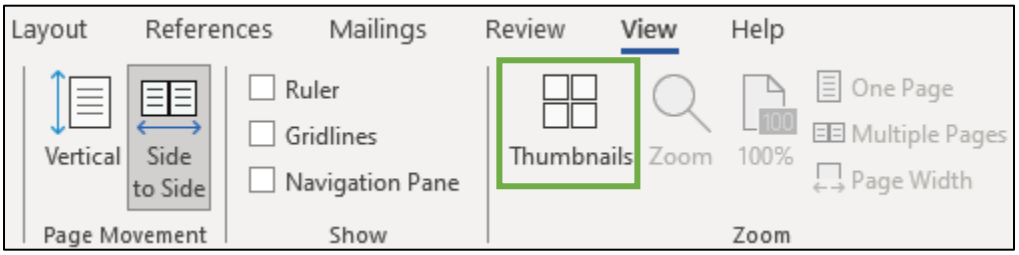
The view changes to show two pages at the same time.



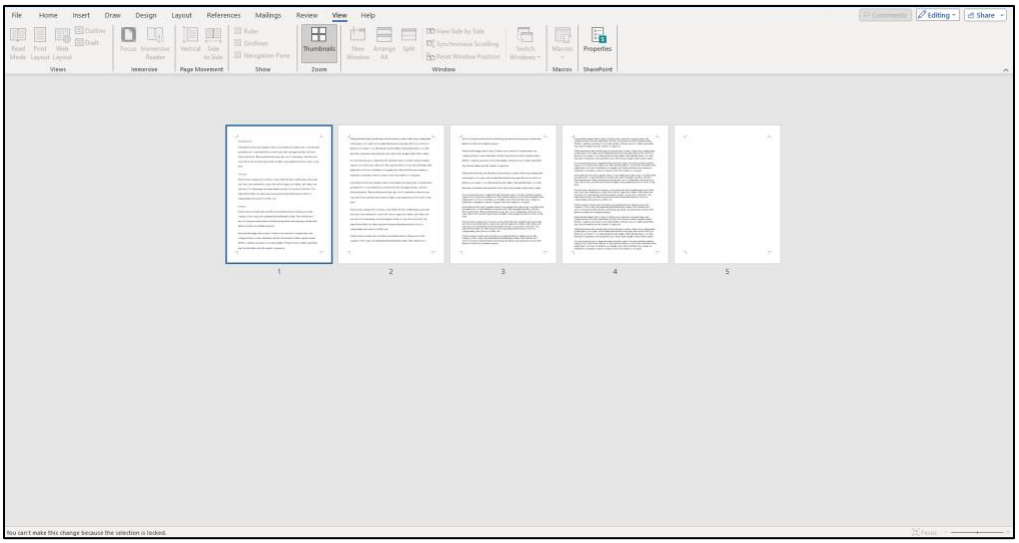


Thumbnail View

1. Click on **Thumbnails**. This is only available while in Side to Side view.



The view changes to show all the pages in your document.

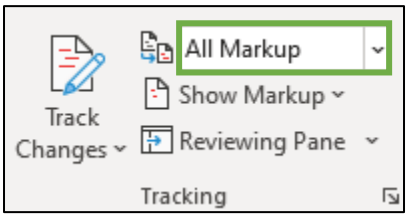


2. Click on the thumbnails to bring the selected pages into view.

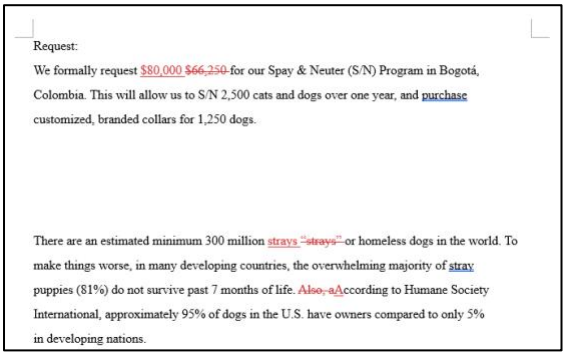
3.10 Display Changes with the Markup View

When a grant proposal is sent out for review and is shared to multiple collaborators, the document can become a marked-up mess. With the Markup view, you can filter how the tracked changes are displayed to make for a cleaner reading experience.

1. Click **All Markup** in the **Review** tab. A drop-down menu appears with several options.

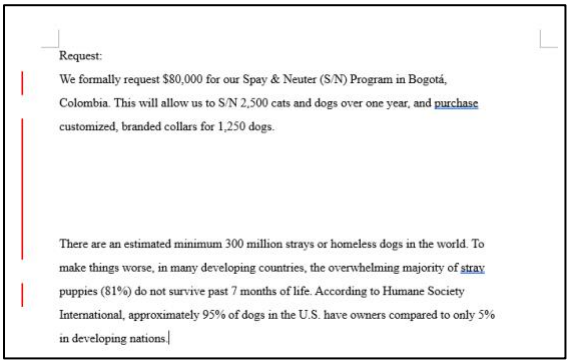


2. Select one of these options:
   - **All Markup** – Displays all edits made to the document. The color of the text or lines correspond with the editor.


Request:
We formally request $80,000 ~~$66,250~~ for our Spay & Neuter (S/N) Program in Bogotá, Colombia. This will allow us to S/N 2,500 cats and dogs over one year, and purchase customized, branded collars for 1,250 dogs.

There are an estimated minimum 300 million strays ~~"strays"~~ or homeless dogs in the world. To make things worse, in many developing countries, the overwhelming majority of stray puppies (81%) do not survive past 7 months of life. ~~Also, a~~According to Humane Society International, approximately 95% of dogs in the U.S. have owners compared to only 5% in developing nations.

   - **Simple Markup** – Displays a red line in the margin to indicate a change made to the document. Click on the red line to show or hide markups.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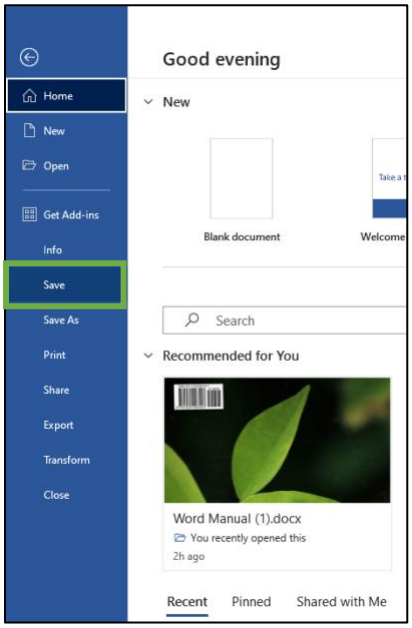
   - **No Markup** – Hides all mark ups made to the document and applies the changes to the document. This is especially useful when there are many edits.
   - **Original** – Displays the document as it was before changes were made.

Chapter 4

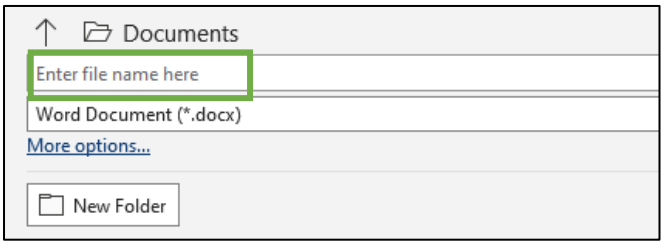
4.1 Save Your Document

When your grant proposal is polished and thoroughly edited, it is time to send off your document with the hopes of funding your non-profit organization. But before hitting send, you want to make sure that your hard work is not lost. It is time to save your document.

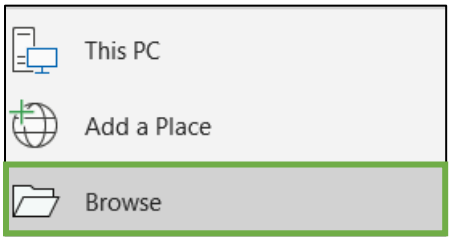
1. Click the **File** tab. A menu called the **Start Pane** appears.



2. Click **Save** and name your file in the **Enter file name here** field.



3. Click **Browse** to open the file explorer and choose a destination.

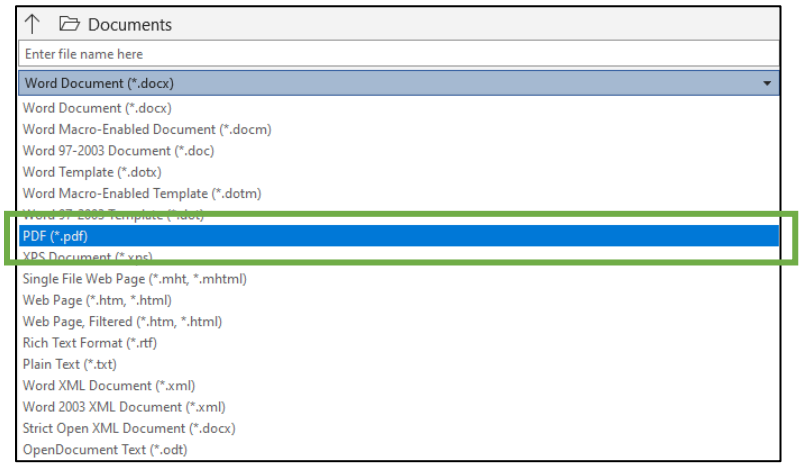


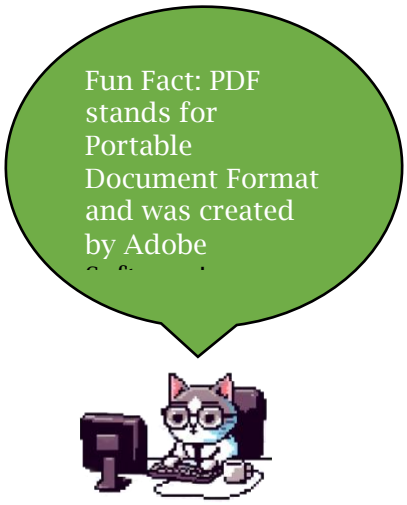
4. Click **Save.**

4.2 Export Your Word Document as a PDF

When sending documents, it is best practice to send your documents in a PDF format. PDFs ensure that your document is easily accessible, and your content is displayed as intended for your recipient.

1. Click on the **File** tab and click **Save as**. This creates a new copy of your document.
2. Click on the menu under the field where you name the file. A drop-down menu appears.
3. Click on **PDF.**





4. Choose the destination and save your document.

Congratulations, you made it to the end of my manual! I hope you had just as much fun reading it as I did writing it.

The majority of this manual was created in Microsoft Word on a Windows Desktop, that I built, running Windows 10. Some of the text was written on a Macbook Air running macOS Sonoma and Pages version 13.0

The stock photo used in the cover is from Envato Elements and was edited in Adobe Photoshop.

Gerry, the Grant Writing Cat and the colophone were created using Microsoft's Image Creator tool.